

H E L L O , A I

Putting AI to Work

Book Two • Complete Edition

by 胖土匪Lecato



Your Guides, Back on Duty

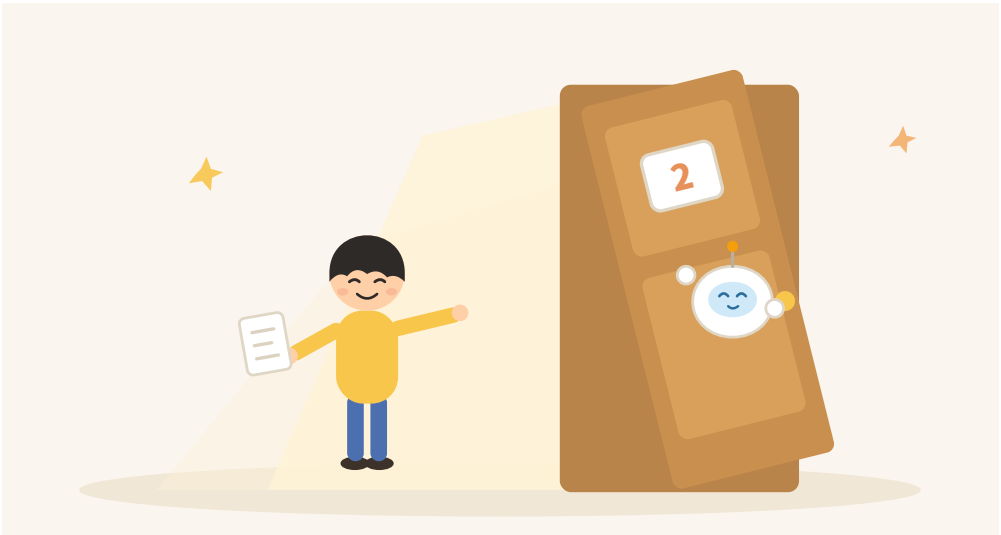


Yoyo and Bubble are back — this time she does the trying, and it shows how it's done.

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Preface • Bring Your Three-Thing List Along



Remember the assignment at the end of Book One — write down the three things you most want AI's help with?

If you wrote it, dig out that slip of paper and tuck it into this page. If you didn't, thirty seconds fixes that. Every chapter ahead exists to help you get the things on that slip actually done, one by one.

First, what this book is — and isn't.

It is not a software manual. Manuals teach you where the buttons are, and the buttons will have moved by next year. This book teaches **craft** — how to

open, how to follow up, how to verify, how to divide the labor. Tools go stale; craft doesn't.

It doesn't pick a tool for you, either. Every method in here works on any mainstream chat AI. You won't need to spend a cent: the free tier is enough to practice this entire book.

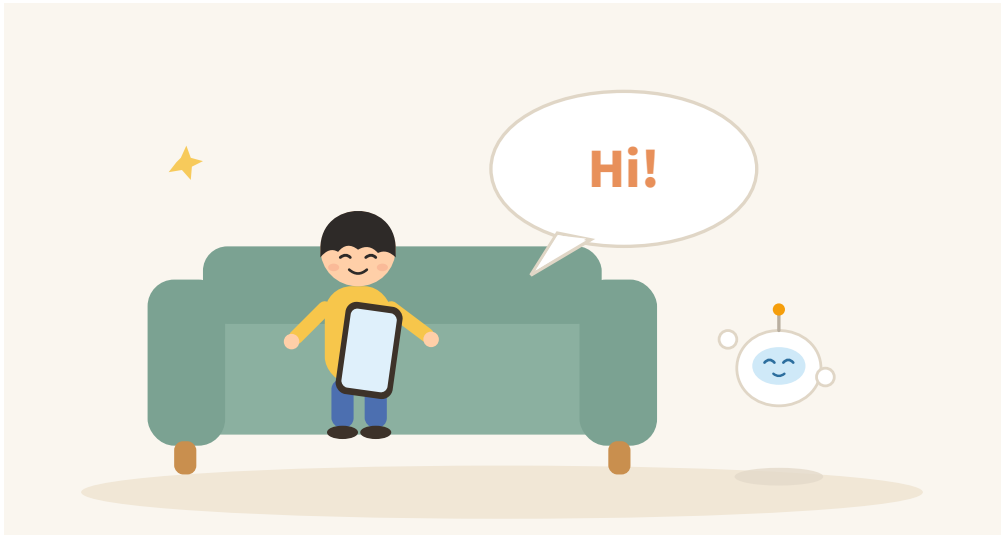
Book One laid the foundation: you know it's a machine that learns patterns from data, you know it plays a word-chain game, you know where it's brilliant and where it's foolish, and you're holding a traffic light. None of that was wasted — **every principle from Book One becomes a practical technique in Book Two.** Why does context improve an answer? The word-chain explains it. What can you safely delegate? The traffic light stands guard.

One reading tip, and only one: **don't just read — do.** Every end-of-chapter exercise fits inside ten minutes. Read a chapter, open your phone, try it once. By the last page, AI will have gone from "I hear it's amazing" to "I use it every day."

The door is open. Bring your list. We start with the very first words.

(End of Preface. Chapter 1: Pick an AI and Say Your First Words.)

Chapter 1 • Pick an AI and Say Your First Words



The Hardest Part Is the Easiest

Plenty of people are stuck in the same spot: heard it's amazing, want to try, never started. The reasons vary — "I'm not technical," "I don't know which one to get," "I wouldn't know what to say," "what if I embarrass myself."

This chapter clears those stones off the road. Start with the good news: **you already understand this machine better than most of its users.** Finishing Book One is like passing the written driving test — you know how it was trained, where it shines, where it stumbles. The actual "driving" is far simpler than you imagine: it's a chat window. If you can text, you can use AI.

Picking a Tool: Three Rules Are Plenty

There are many AI assistants, and the names change often, so no brand endorsements here — just three picking rules:

One: choose a major company's offering that ranks high in your app store. The mainstream assistants have all passed the basic bars for capability and safety; a beginner can't go far wrong with any of them.

Two: a chat-style one is all you need. Everything this book teaches works on a basic chat AI — one that takes text, voice, and pictures.

Three: the free tier is enough. No spending required to get started. The day you feel "free isn't enough for me anymore" is the day you've graduated — and you'll know exactly what to upgrade.

And don't agonize over "choosing wrong." The craft in this book transfers to every one of them. Switching AIs is like switching restaurants: you hold the chopsticks the same way.

The Interface: You Only Need to Find Four Things

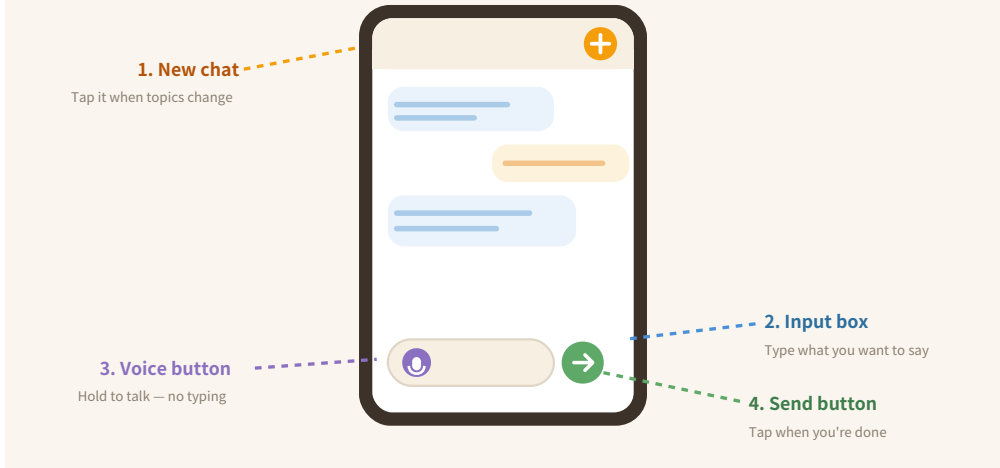
However fancy the app looks, you only need to recognize four things:

The input box — where you type. **The send button** — press it when you're done. **The voice button** — hold and talk instead of typing; a gift for anyone who hates keyboards, exactly like sending a voice message. **The new-chat button** — usually a "+" or a pencil icon, for changing topics (why that matters comes at the end of this chapter).

Every other button can wait. Truly.

The Interface Map: Only Four Things

Figure 1-1 | Ignore every other button for now



What to Say First: Talk Like You Talk

Where beginners freeze: "What do I type? Don't I need to learn those magic incantations?"

No. **Use plain speech, as if talking to a capable friend.** Unlearn the keyword habit that search engines taught you — instead of "cold symptoms relief methods," just say: "I think I'm coming down with a cold, sore throat and a bit of a cough. What can I do tonight to feel better?" The more like natural speech, the better the answer. That's not magic — it's Book One's word-chain principle: it read billions of sentences of human talk, so human talk is its home field.

If you still don't know where to start, here are three kinds of **zero-risk starter questions**, all deep in the traffic light's green zone:

Ask facts — the things you've always wondered but felt silly asking a person: "What's actually the difference between stocks and funds?" "Why can planes fly?"

Get ideas — use it as an idea bank: "I've got eggs, tomatoes, and some noodles. What can dinner be? Give me three ideas."

Ask a rewrite — hand it something you wrote: "Make this message more polite: 'Can't make it this week, sorry.'"



Three Mental Stumbling Blocks, Removed

"I'm afraid my question is dumb." — It has no eye-roll function. It doesn't judge, doesn't laugh, doesn't gossip, and doesn't tire of the same question asked a hundred times. The safest place in the world for a "dumb question" is right there.

"I'm afraid I'll say it wrong." — Then say it again. Zero cost. This isn't an exam and nobody's grading. Besides, you already know its answers need checking too (Book One, Chapter 6) — so neither of you gets to be smug.

"I'm afraid it'll mislead me." — Which is why we start in the green zone: ideas, rewrites, common knowledge — mistakes that cost nothing. Checking important facts and making big decisions can wait until Chapter 8 hands you the safety gear.

One Small Habit: New Topic, New Chat

One habit worth forming on day one: **finish one matter, tap "new chat" before the next.**

The reason appeared in Book One's dictionary — "context." Within one conversation it carries everything said so far into how it reads what comes next. Chat about your dog's illness in the morning, then ask for a leave-of-absence note in the same window that afternoon, and you may get a note that cites your sick dog. New topic, new window. Clean and simple.

Chapter Takeaways

1. Three picking rules: major maker, chat-style, start free — any choice works, the craft transfers.
2. Learn four things on the screen: input, send, voice, new chat. Open with plain speech — the more human it sounds, the better it answers.
3. It doesn't judge, and wrong costs nothing. Warm up with the three green-zone starters: ask facts, get ideas, ask a rewrite. New topic — new chat.

Try It Yourself: The Opening Three

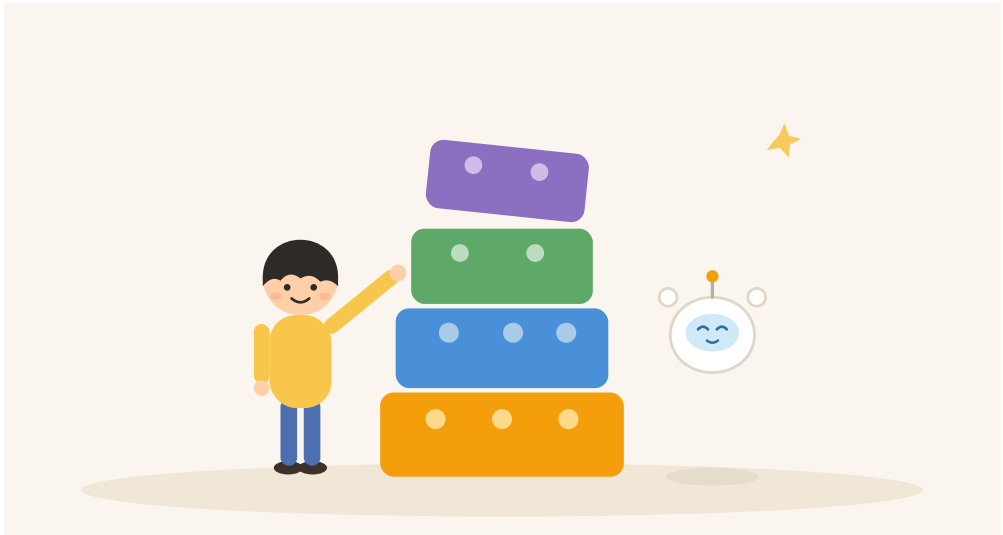
Open your chosen AI right now. Ten minutes, three moves:

1. Ask one thing you've always been curious about;
2. Report three ingredients from your fridge and ask for three dinner ideas;
3. Paste a message you're about to send someone and ask it to be "more polite / more concise" — compare before and after, then send.

Do those three and you're officially on the road. Next chapter, your questions jump a whole level.

(End of Chapter 1. Next: Chapter 2, "The Craft of Asking: Four Building Blocks.")

Chapter 2 • The Craft of Asking: Four Building Blocks



Same AI — Why Are Their Answers Better Than Mine?

A few days in, you may notice something: on the very same AI, some people get answers that are sharp and tailored, while yours come back generic. The difference isn't the AI. It's the asking.

The good news: "asking well" isn't a talent, it's a craft — and the whole craft is four building blocks.

First, Book One explains *why* the asking matters so much. Remember: it plays word-chain, and **every word you give is a signpost for which road it**

takes. Say only "write me a birthday message," and it faces ten thousand forks — for whom? what occasion? what relationship? It can only take the most average road, so you receive a paragraph anyone could use and no one is moved by. Add one sentence — "it's my dad's sixtieth; he's a fishing-mad old softie who acts gruff" — and ten thousand forks collapse into one.

Context isn't filler. Context is the signpost.

The Four Blocks: Role, Context, Task, Format

Take a good question apart and you find exactly four pieces:

Block one: Role — tell it who to be. "You're a patient family doctor." "You're a veteran HR manager." Given a role, it summons that role's knowledge, tone, and judgment — word-chain again: in its textbook, doctors talk the way doctors talk.

Block two: Context — tell it who *you* are and what's going on. This is the most valuable block of the four. "I know nothing about investing." "The reader is my old boss and we've grown distant." "Budget is four hundred dollars." The more specific the context, the more the answer fits.

Block three: Task — say what to do, with a concrete verb. "List," "compare," "rewrite," "find the flaws" all beat a mushy "take a look."

Block four: Format — define what the result looks like. "Under 200 words." "As a table." "Three options, ordered from cheapest to easiest." "Keep the tone light." Skip this and you get its default — usually an essay.

The Four Building Blocks of a Question

Figure 2-1 | Not all needed every time — but context is gold

Role

"You are a patient family doctor"

Context

"I'm a total beginner" • "reader = my old boss" • "budget \$400"



Task

"List" "Compare" "Rewrite" — be concrete

Format

"200 words max" "as a table" "light tone"

Why it works: every word is a signpost for the chain — context narrows ten thousand forks to one

Can't remember them? One fallback: "What do you need to know? Ask me first."

Seeing Is Believing: One Before-and-After

Enough theory. Task: message the teacher to ask for a day off for your child.

Blocks unassembled: "Write me an absence note."

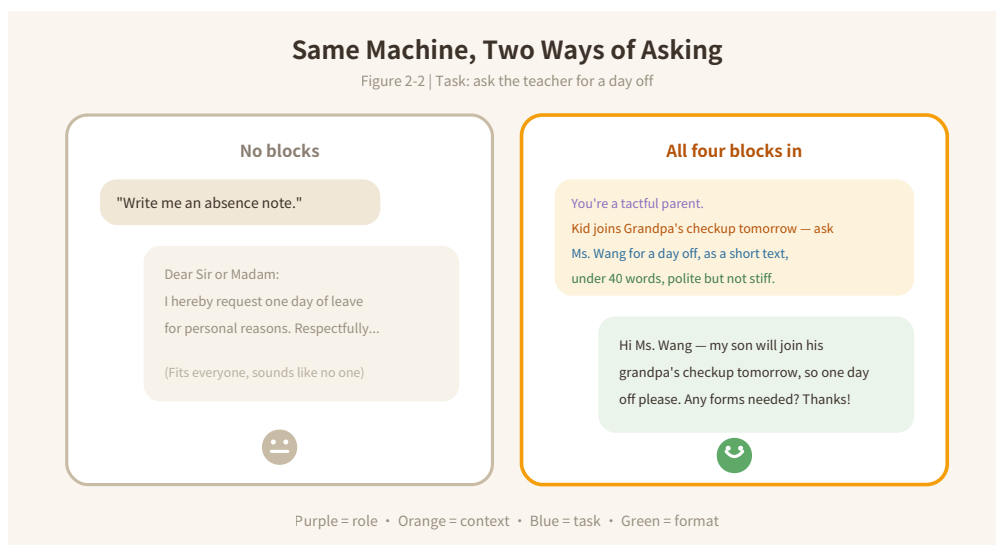
You'll likely get a stiff, formal template addressed "Dear Sir or Madam" — you gave it nothing, so it took the most average road.

All four blocks in: "You're a tactful parent (role). My third-grader needs to accompany his grandfather to a hospital check-up tomorrow, and I want to ask his teacher Ms. Wang — we're on friendly terms — for one day off (context). Write it as a short text message (task), under forty words, polite but not stiff, ending by asking if any paperwork is needed (format)."

This time you get a message you can send as-is. **Same machine, two ways of asking, a world apart.**

Same Machine, Two Ways of Asking

Figure 2-2 | Task: ask the teacher for a day off



Three Common Doubts

"Four blocks every time? Exhausting." — Not every time. "How do I scramble eggs" needs zero blocks. The rule: **the more important and personal the matter, the more blocks it deserves**. Casual question, casual ask.

"Does the order matter?" — No. Say them as they come to you, even across several messages. It doesn't care about format; it cares about information.

"What if I can't remember four things?" — Then remember one: **context**. It carries the most weight. And if even organizing that feels like work, use the universal fallback — kick the ball back to it: "I want help with such-and-such. **What do you need to know? Ask me first.**" Let it interview you. The results are often startlingly good.

Chapter Takeaways

1. The asking decides the answer: every word is a signpost — context collapses ten thousand forks into one.
2. Four blocks: role, context, task, format. Not all needed every time, but important matters deserve more blocks — and context is gold.
3. The universal fallback: "What do you need to know? Ask me first."

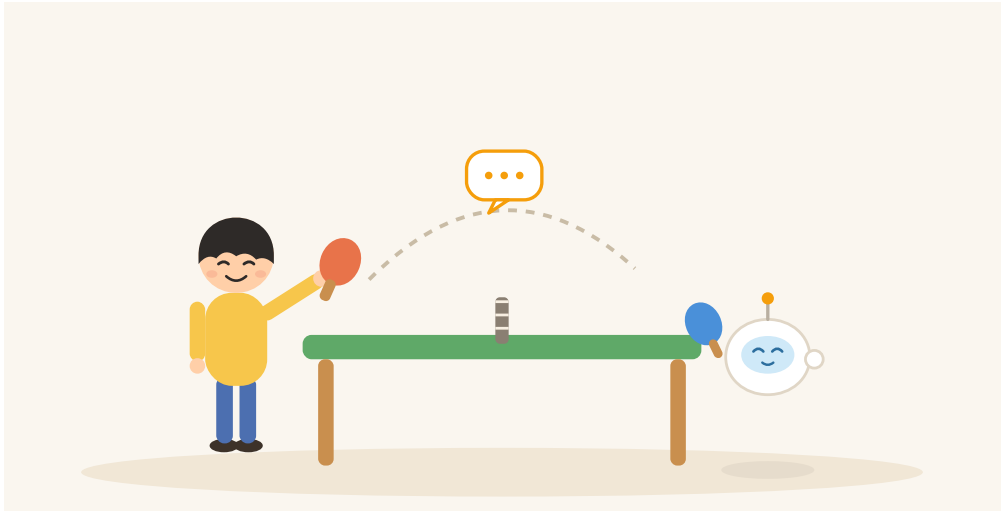
Try It Yourself: Old Question, New Ask

Dig up any question you asked an AI last week (or reuse Chapter 1's exercise). Re-ask it with all four blocks assembled.

Put the two answers side by side. That comparison will teach you more than ten thousand words of this chapter.

(End of Chapter 2. Next: Chapter 3, "The Art of the Follow-Up" — good answers aren't asked into being; they're polished into being.)

Chapter 3 • The Art of the Follow-Up



First, the Most Common Mistake of All

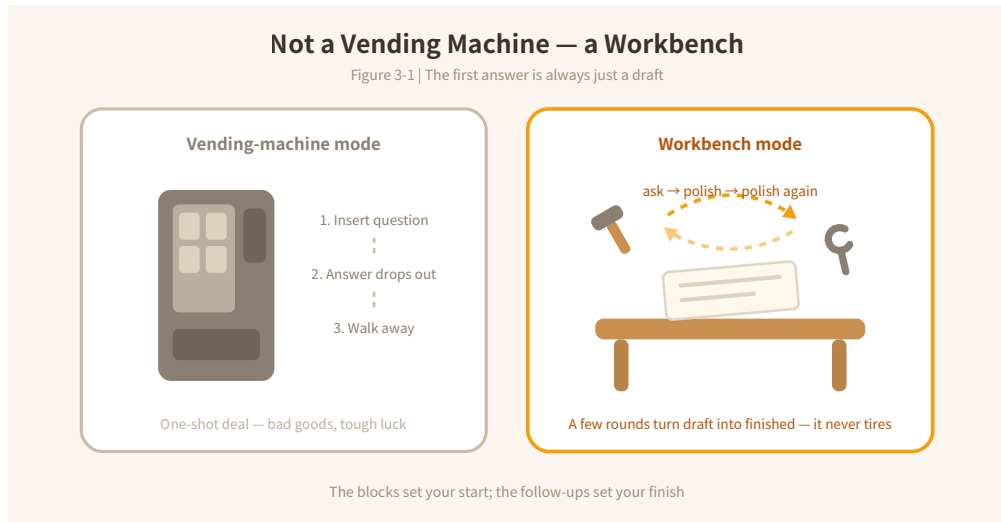
Most people use AI like this: ask a question, receive an answer, think "eh, not bad, not great," close the app.

That's treating AI as a **vending machine**: coin in, product out, transaction over. Goods disappointing? Blame the machine.

Skilled users treat it as a **workbench**: the first answer is only ever a draft, and then the back-and-forth begins — "fix this part," "different direction," "simpler" — three to five rounds later, the draft is a finished piece.

That's the whole gap. Chapter 2's blocks set how high you start; this chapter's follow-up craft sets how high you finish. **Good answers are rarely**

asked into being. They are almost always polished into being. And polishing costs you nothing — it doesn't get annoyed, doesn't get tired, will happily revise a hundred times. No human collaborator offers that luxury.



Five Follow-Up Lines That Cover 90% of Cases

Following up needs no eloquence, only direction. Memorize these five (or copy them into your notes app):

Line one: say what's not working. "Too long — cut it in half." "Good opening, but the second half sounds like an ad." "Keep point two, drop the rest." Don't be shy — critiquing a person takes courage; critiquing it takes none. The more specific your complaint, the closer the next version.

Line two: "Change the angle — give me three more." First batch bland? Send it down a different road: "These are too safe; three bolder ones." "Rethink it from a money-saving angle." It has plenty in the tank, but unprompted it serves the safest batch — remember, the chain defaults to the most-traveled road.

Line three: "Simpler, with an example." If an answer loses you, that's not your failure — it's tuned to the wrong channel. "Explain it like I've never heard of this." "Give me an everyday analogy." The difficulty dial is yours to turn, any time.

Line four: "Switch roles and look again." The underrated one. Plan drafted? Make it attack its own work: "Now you're a picky client — where does this proposal fall apart?" "Imagine you received this message. How does it land?" Let it spar with itself; you collect the winnings.

Line five: "What else do you need?" When answers feel like they're scratching through a boot, it's usually missing information. Ask directly: "To do this well, what else do you need from me?" — Chapter 2's fallback, just as effective mid-conversation.

Five Follow-Up Lines for 90% of Cases

Figure 3-2 | Copy them into your notes app

1

Say what's not working

"Too long — cut it in half." "Good opening; the rest sounds like an ad."

2

Change the angle — three more

"Too safe — three bolder ones." "Rethink it from a money-saving angle."

3

Simpler, with an example

"Explain it like I've never heard of this." "Use an everyday analogy."

4

Switch roles and re-read it

"Now you're a picky client — find the holes, then fix them."

5

What else do you need?

"To do this well, what do you still need from me? Ask first."

Bonus — give examples: paste one you love, say "match this flavor" — one good, one bad beats ten adjectives

Giving an Example: the Highest-Leverage Sentence

One more move deserves its own section: **instead of describing what you want, show it something you like.**

"Make it warmer" — a thousand people hold a thousand meanings of "warm." Instead: "I love the feel of the passage below. Match this flavor," and paste a paragraph you admire. Learning patterns from examples is literally its entire skill set (Chapter 3 of Book One, old friend).

The reverse works too: "Don't write it like this," pasting the style you hate. One positive example and one negative example beat ten adjectives.

Keep Polishing, or Open a New Chat?

Two rules of thumb:

Keep polishing when it's still the same job, just not good enough yet — tone, angle, detail. Stay in the conversation; it remembers the whole history and each round gets easier.

Open a new chat in two cases. One: the topic has genuinely changed (Chapter 1's rule). Two: **when revisions start making things worse** — after too many rounds, your accumulated instructions can start fighting each other and the answers turn into mush. The fix isn't more patching. Open a fresh chat, and state everything you've learned you want — in four clean blocks — right in the opening message. The old conversation's lessons become the new conversation's head start.

Chapter Takeaways

1. Not a vending machine — a workbench. The first answer is always a draft; good answers get polished into being, and it never tires of polishing.
2. Five follow-up lines: name the flaw, change the angle, simplify with examples, switch roles for self-critique, ask what it's missing. Plus the bonus: one good and one bad example beat ten adjectives.
3. Same job, keep polishing in place; new topic or worsening mush — new chat, opening with everything you've learned.

Try It Yourself: Polish 60 Points into 90

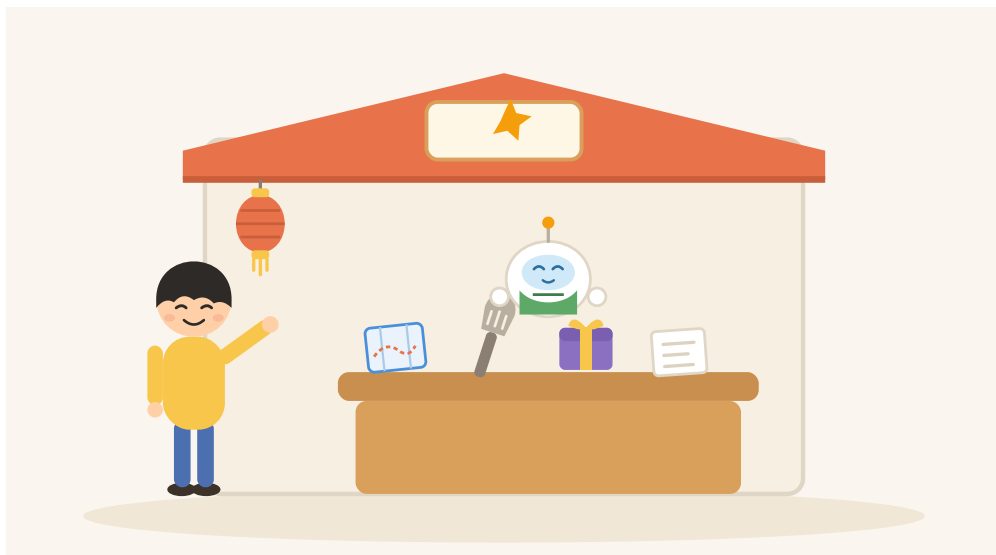
Take the four-block answer from Chapter 2's exercise. First versions are banned; follow up three rounds:

Round one, name the thing you like least. Round two, demand "a version from a different angle." Round three, "switch to the recipient's perspective, find the flaws, then fix them."

Compare version one and version four. From today, version four is where your standards live.

(End of Chapter 3. Next: Chapter 4, "The Everyday Fix-It Shop" — first live missions in the green zone.)

Chapter 4 • The Everyday Fix-It Shop



Craft Learned — Open for Business

Three chapters in, you can open, build blocks, and polish. The craft is complete; now we take jobs.

We start with the four most common categories of everyday life. All of them sit in the traffic light's green and light-yellow zones: **you can judge the result at a glance, and mistakes don't hurt**. Each comes with a copy-and-use template — but remember, a template is only an opening stance. The real results come from the context you pour in and the two or three follow-up rounds after.

Job One: Trip Planning — a Rough Plan That Knows You

The internet is full of itineraries — other people's. AI's value is **making one to your measurements, on the spot.**

Template: "Plan a **-day trip to __ (destination). Traveling: __ (who — e.g., a six-year-old and a seventy-year-old grandpa). Our pace: __ (e.g., slow mornings, two sights a day max). Budget** . We especially want __ (e.g., local food); we especially don't want __ (e.g., long lines). Give me a rough plan first, marking each day's physical load."

Then polish: "Day two's too heavy — shift some to day three." "Swap the museum for something kid-friendly."

One yellow-light warning: hand it the structure, but **opening hours, ticket prices, reservation rules — the facts that change — you check on official channels yourself.** Remember Book One's "the textbook has a deadline"? This is exactly where it goes stale.

Job Two: Fridge Cleanup — Report Ingredients, Receive Recipes

The most addictive daily use there is: open the fridge and report everything.

Template: "At home I have , , __ (report honestly — half a carrot counts). Equipment: __. My cooking level: __ (beginner/okay/confident). I want __ servings of __ (something quick / hearty / light). Give me two or three options with rough time needed."

Follow up freely: "No bean paste for option two — what substitutes?" "Make it a no-spice version for a kid."

Cooking is pure green light: worst case you order takeout, and its combinations are frequently a pleasant surprise.

Job Three: Shopping — an Advisor, Not a Decider

Pre-purchase agonizing is prime AI territory — used correctly.

Template: "I'm torn between ___ and ___ (or have it nominate: 'list three ___ suitable for '). **My use case:** . What I value most: ___ (e.g., quiet, durable, easy to clean). Budget ___. Give me a comparison table — each one's strengths, weaknesses, who it suits — then tell me which you'd lean toward for my situation, and why."

It is excellent at organizing how to compare, and will fish you out of the swamp of thirty reviews. But two yellow-light rules: **verify current prices and models in the store yourself** (the deadline problem again), and **the money decision is yours** — it's an advisor, not your accountant.

Job Four: Personal Messages — Let It Break the Ice

Birthday toasts, wedding wishes, apologies, gentle refusals, condolences — hard to write, and not because of prose. Because of starting. Let AI hand you a first version, then edit until it sounds like you.

Template: "Write something for ___ (occasion). It's for ___ (relationship + what they're like — the more specific the better: 'my dad, sixty, fishing-mad, acts gruff, soft inside'). The core thing I want to say: ___. Tone: ___ (sincere but not gushing / light with a little humor). Under ___ words. No clichés."

The key move comes after: **swap out every word you wouldn't actually say**. AI drafts; you supply the humanity. That division of labor governs every ghost-writing scenario from here on.

What This Chapter Is Really Teaching

Four jobs in, you've probably spotted the pattern they share:

Report your situation → take the draft → polish with follow-ups → verify the changeable facts yourself → make the final call yourself.

That loop opens every door. Anything in life that "needs a bit of homework" — moving house, adopting a pet, rescuing a dying plant, writing a community notice — runs on the same loop. The fix-it shop's sign really only says one thing: **if a mistake wouldn't hurt, just ask.**

Chapter Takeaways

1. Four green-zone starters: trips get rough plans, fridges get recipes, purchases get comparison tables, hard messages get first drafts — templates open, context and follow-ups deliver.
2. Two yellow-light disciplines throughout: changeable facts (prices, hours, models) you verify; money and final calls stay with you.
3. The universal loop: report → draft → polish → verify → decide. If a mistake wouldn't hurt, just ask.

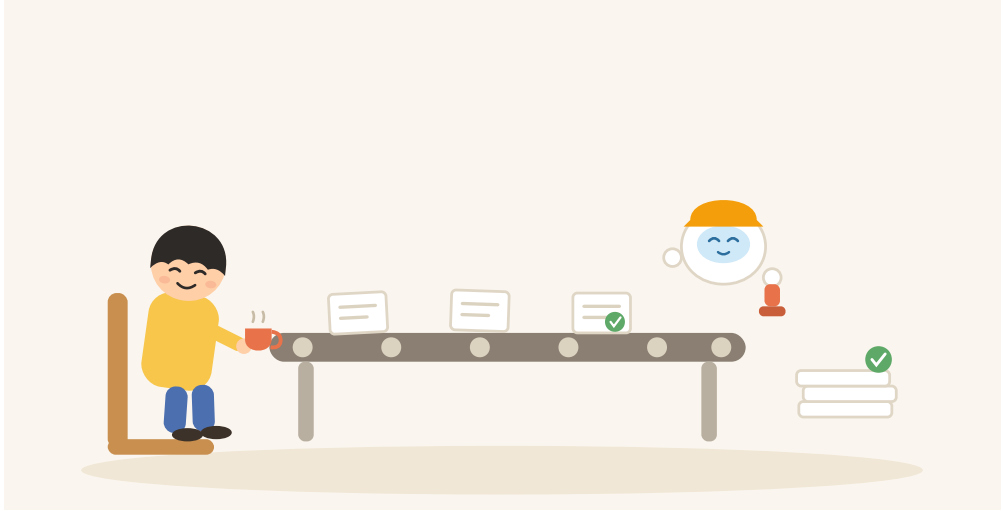
Try It Yourself: Take a Real Job

Pick whichever of the four you'll genuinely need this week (weekend cooking? a birthday message for an elder?). Open with the template, follow up at least twice, then **actually use the result** — cook that meal, send those wishes.

The moment it leaves your phone is the moment AI actually enters your life.

(End of Chapter 4. Next: Chapter 5, "The Work Accelerator.")

Chapter 5 • The Work Accelerator



At Work, the Ledger Runs by the Minute

Life-zone mistakes don't hurt; work is a different ledger — every saved block of time is real money, every slipped error may come with a bill. So each technique in this chapter carries its own discipline: **where to floor the pedal, and where your hands must stay on the wheel.**

Four battlefields: writing emails and messages, reading long documents, tidying meeting notes, and framing reports. What they share: they are all **format labor** — time-consuming, but not really requiring your unique judgment. Exactly what AI should take over.

Battlefield One: Email and Messages — Tone Is a Dial

The exhausting part of work communication isn't the content, it's the calibration: the same matter reads differently to your boss, a peer, a client, or the supplier who's ignored three reminders.

Treat tone as a dial and hand it over:

Template: "Write a __ (email/message) to __ (who + relationship). The matter: __ (state it plainly). My goal: __ (chase progress / decline politely / apologize / lobby for resources). Set the tone to: __ — it must **, without seeming**. Give me two versions: one safe, one direct."

Asking for two versions is a habit worth keeping: a second version costs it nothing, and choosing between two beats staring at one wondering "should I tweak it?"

The iron rule before sending is singular: **your eyes on every word**. Names, dates, amounts, promises — the places it might "chain" wrong (Book One's old hallucination ailment). Once it leaves the outbox, it's yours.

Battlefield Two: Long Documents — Three Steps, Yellow Lights On

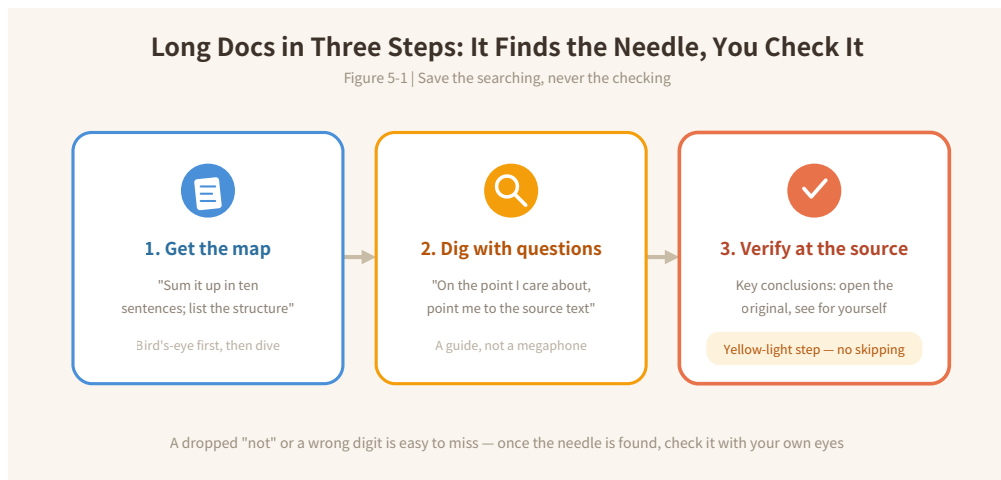
Fifty-page reports, policy documents, draft contracts — delegating the reading is an enormous liberation. But delegated reading is not **replaced** reading. The standard three steps:

Step one, get the map: "What does this document cover? Summarize in ten sentences; list its structure."

Step two, dig with questions: "On ___ (the thing you actually care about) — what does it say? Point me to the original passages."

Step three, verify at the source: for every conclusion that matters, open the original at that spot and see it with your own eyes.

Why can't step three be skipped? Because long-document summaries are textbook yellow-zone: mostly right, and when wrong — a dropped "not," a misread number — you may never notice. **It finds the needle in the haystack; you confirm it's really a needle.** Ten documents on this loop still beat close-reading them yourself, by a mile — you save the searching, never the responsibility of seeing.



Battlefield Three: Meeting Notes — from Transcript to Action List

Meeting tools transcribe audio now, but what comes out is porridge. Pour the porridge in:

Template: "Below is a raw meeting transcript. Organize it into three parts: ① topics discussed and each conclusion; ② the action list — who, by when, does what (flag items with no clear owner); ③ open disagreements and undecided items."

Then sweep it once yourself, double-checking **names and dates** — the two things that must not be wrong. Post the action list to the group chat and you're suddenly the most reliable person on the team.

Battlefield Four: Report Frames — Skeleton from It, Flesh from You

Weekly updates, project reviews, proposals — the hardest part is the zero-to-one of the blank page. Have it deliver bones:

Template: "I'm preparing a ___ (weekly update / project report / proposal) for ___ (audience). My core message: **. What they care about most: .** Build me a structure — which sections, what each covers, in what order, with two or three prompt-points per section. **I'll fill in the content myself.**"

That last sentence is deliberate. **Structure can be outsourced; the viewpoint cannot.** The data is yours, the judgment is yours — and only then is the credit yours. It builds the stage; you perform.

And one discipline in passing: **company data and unreleased information — think before you feed it to an AI.** That's a preview of Chapter 8; for now, one line: when unsure, anonymize first, or simply don't send.

Chapter Takeaways

1. Email: tone is a dial, always request two versions; before sending, your eyes on every word — names, dates, amounts above all.
2. Long documents in three steps: map → dig → verify at the source. It finds the needle; you check it. Save the searching, never the seeing.
3. Meetings become "conclusions + action list + open items" (verify names and dates); reports take only a skeleton — views and data stay yours. Think before feeding company information in.

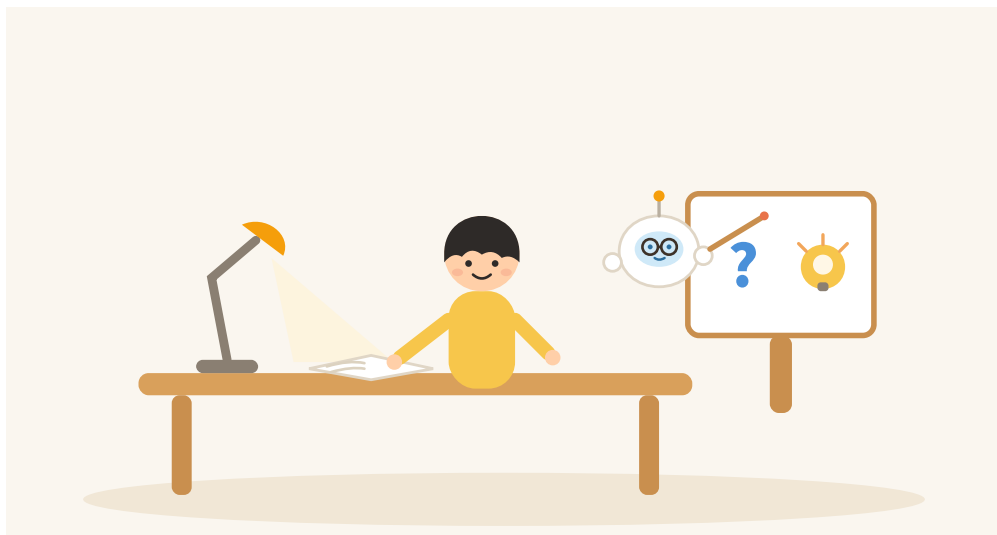
Try It Yourself: Steal Back Thirty Minutes

This week, hand it one real task: a difficult email, a document you had no time to read, or the notes from your next meeting.

Run the chapter's loop, then estimate the minutes saved. Those thirty minutes are this book's first direct wage payment to you.

(End of Chapter 5. Next: Chapter 6, "A Tutor in Your Pocket" — learn anything with AI.)

Chapter 6 • A Tutor in Your Pocket



You May Now Own History's Greatest Luxury

A one-on-one tutor, on call around the clock, fluent in every subject, infinitely patient with any question, awake at 3 a.m., and free — emperors couldn't assemble that package. It's in your phone.

Cold water first, though: **most people use this tutor as someone to copy homework from.** "Write my book report." "What's the answer to this one?" — The answer arrives; the ability stays where it was. Book One's Chapter 9 line lands hardest right here: it may write for you; it must not think for you.

Used right, it's the greatest sparring partner in history. Used wrong, it's the fastest way to get worse. This chapter teaches the sparring version — three magic lines in total.

Line One: "Explain It to Me" — the Difficulty Dial Is Yours

The tallest wall in learning anything new: jargon explained with more jargon. This tutor's signature trick: **difficulty adjusts to you.**

The opener: "Explain ___ to me. Treat me as someone who's never touched this. No jargon. Lots of analogies."

Understood a layer? Turn the dial up: "Good — go a step deeper, but define every new term as you go."

Lost? Turn it down: "Stop — I didn't get '___.' Explain that first." Or change the channel: "Give me an analogy from cooking / driving / raising kids."

This is Chapter 3's "simpler, please" line in study clothes. At school you'd hesitate to ask the teacher a third time. Here, the thirtieth explanation comes with the same patience as the first.

Line Two: "Quiz Me" — Mr. Feynman's Old Trick

Between feeling you've learned something and actually having learned it runs a river. The old way across: explain it to someone, or get tested. This tutor does both.

Have it test you: "I just learned ___. Give me five questions, easy to hard. I answer one, you grade one — explain my mistakes, and no answers in advance."

You explain, it probes (the fiercer version — the famous Feynman method): "I'll explain __ to you. Play a student who loves to push back: wherever I'm unclear, press me." Where you stall is exactly what you haven't truly understood. One try tells all.

Learning without testing is barely learning. The old excuse was having no one to test you. That excuse is now extinct.

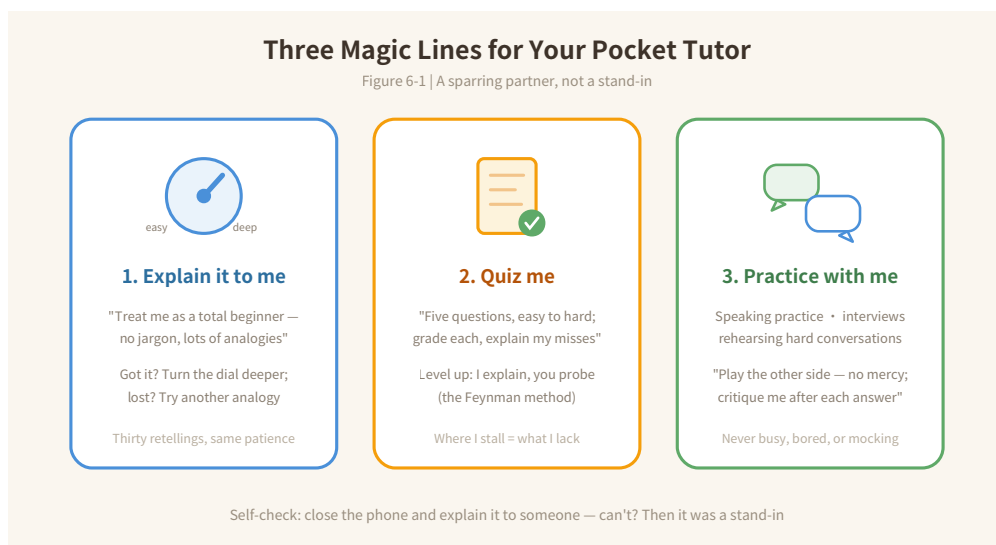
Line Three: "Practice with Me" — Anything That Needs a Partner

Some skills can't be understood into existence; they must be drilled: languages need speaking, interviews need sparring, negotiations need rounds. For anything that needs an opponent, it is the perfect partner — never busy, never bored, never laughing at you.

Language practice: "Chat with me in English about everyday things, simple words. When I make mistakes, don't interrupt — let me finish the sentence, then correct me and show the natural phrasing." (Pair with the voice button and you carry a conversation corner in your pocket.)

Mock interviews: "You're the interviewer for a __ position, style __ (tough / warm). One question at a time. After each answer, critique: what worked, where I wobbled, how to answer better. Full review at the end."

Rehearsing hard conversations: raising a salary talk with your boss, a disagreement with family? Have it play the other side first: "Play my boss. His likely concerns: __. I'll open; respond with his logic. No mercy." Three rehearsals before the real thing changes everything.



One Line Not to Cross: Sparring, Never Substituting

Plain words to close, especially for parents helping kids with homework:

Using it to find which problem is wrong, or to explain the thinking behind a missed problem — good use. Copying its answers — bad use.

The difference is one thing only: the turn in the brain — did you (or your child) make it, or did it make it for you?

A humble self-check: after learning something with AI, close the phone and explain it to another person. If it comes out, that was sparring. If it doesn't, that was substitution.

Chapter Takeaways

1. Three magic lines: **explain it to me** (the dial and the analogies are yours), **quiz me** (graded one by one; the fierce version — you explain, it

probes: Feynman), **practice with me** (languages, interviews, hard conversations — a partner who never tires).

2. Learned means tested, tested means explained aloud: where you stall is what you don't yet own.
3. One line: sparring, never substituting — the turn in the brain must be your own. Whatever you can't explain with the phone closed, you haven't learned.

Try It Yourself: Learn Something New in Twenty Minutes

Pick a small thing you've always meant to understand (index funds? blood pressure numbers? the photosynthesis in your kid's textbook), and run the three lines:

"Explain it to me" (five minutes) → "Five questions, quiz me" (ten minutes)
→ close the phone and explain it to someone at home (five minutes).

The moment you finish explaining, you'll notice something: the price of "learning one new thing" has fallen to twenty minutes.

(End of Chapter 6. Next: Chapter 7, "A Creative Partner" — from writing to painting.)

Chapter 7 • A Creative Partner



This Chapter Is the Fun One

The previous chapters handled business — saving time, getting things done. This one is for joy: **creating**. Writing the piece you've postponed for years, inventing a bedtime story, making a one-of-a-kind greeting card, painting the picture that so far exists only in your head.

These things used to have entry fees: prose skill, drawing skill, software skill. The fees have dropped to the floor.

But before work begins, the house rule — this chapter's refrain: **it is a partner, not a ghostwriter**. A partner helps turn your ideas into work; a

ghostwriter does the ideas too. The first makes you stronger with use. The second hollows you out.

Writing Together: a Four-Step Line

Whatever the piece — a blog post, a toast, a letter to an old friend — the line runs the same four steps:

Step one, brainstorm: quantity first. "I want to write about __. Ten angles." "Ten titles." "Five ways to open." Don't fear the pile: nine duds out of ten is normal — you're shopping for the one that makes your eyes light up. Too tame? Chapter 3's line: "Too safe. Three bolder ones."

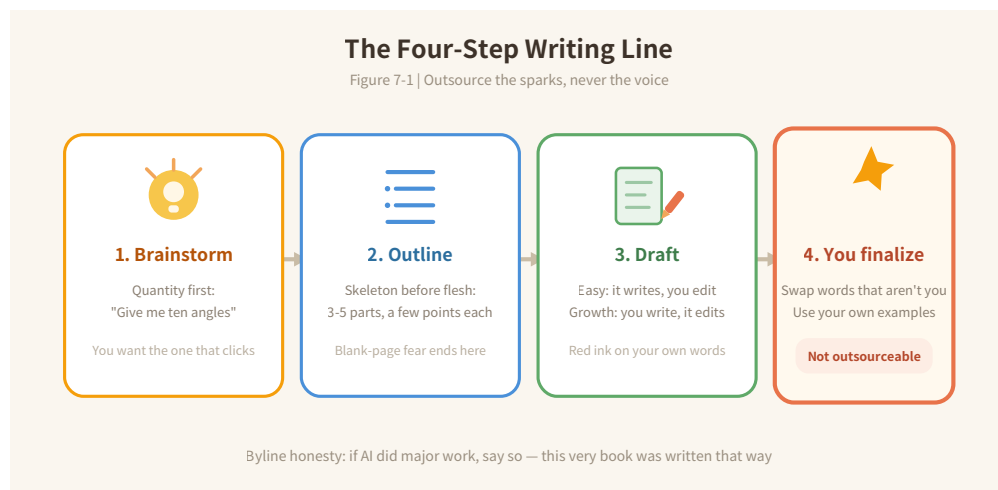
Step two, outline: skeleton before flesh. Angle chosen: "Build an outline on this angle — three to five parts, two or three points each." With bones in place, writing stops being facing a blank page and becomes filling in squares. Blank-page terror ends here.

Step three, draft: pick your division of labor. Easy mode — it writes, you edit: "Draft it from the outline, tone __, about __ words." Growth mode — you write, it edits: "Here's my draft. Show me where it rambles and where the logic snaps — explain why before each fix." Choose growth mode if you want your writing to improve: red ink on your own words is what teaches.

Step four, you finalize: pour in your voice. This step cannot be outsourced. Swap every word you wouldn't say (Chapter 4's rule). Replace its examples with your own lived ones. Delete any sentence you don't actually believe.

Words can be co-written; the views under your byline must be yours.

On bylines, one honest sentence: if AI did major creative work on something you publish, say so openly. There's no shame in it — the book in your hands was written exactly this way, and the cover says so.



Painting with AI: Four Elements of a Clear Picture

From writing to painting. The principle in one line (Book One, Chapter 5): it "carves" a picture out of noise step by step, and **your description is the direction it carves** — so half the quality of the picture is the clarity of your words.

A working description breaks into four elements:

Subject — what to paint. "A cat" is fog; "an orange cat in a red scarf sitting on a windowsill" is a subject.

Style — what look. Storybook, watercolor, ink wash, pixel art, "photo-realistic"... say nothing and it rolls the dice for you.

Details — features worth stressing. Fluffy fur, round eyes, paws on the sill. Pick the two or three that matter; don't pile on.

Mood — light and feeling. Winter-morning sunlight, quiet and warm. Or: rainy, bustling, mysterious. Mood words often decide the picture's whole flavor.

Strung together: "Storybook style, an orange cat in a red scarf sitting on a windowsill, fluffy, winter morning sun, quiet and warm." — a fully qualified picture prompt.

Not satisfied? **Every follow-up skill transfers whole:** "smaller scarf," "snowy background," "warmer overall." Fixing a picture and fixing a paragraph are the same craft.

One expectations note: remember Book One on fingers and lettering? **The more a picture demands exactness, the more likely it stumbles.** Treat it as an inspiration and sketch tool, not a precision instrument.

Copyright and Courtesy: Two Reminders

First, **copyright:** who owns AI-generated content, and whether you may sell it, varies by platform terms and is still evolving by region. Keeping it for yourself or posting to friends — little to worry about. **Commercial use** (printing on products, selling commissions) — read your platform's terms first. Don't assume.

Second, courtesy that doubles as a floor: **don't deliberately imitate a living creator's signature style for publication or profit.** That it's technically possible doesn't make it right. The working custom of the creative world: homage, yes; impersonation, no.

Chapter Takeaways

1. Writing runs a four-step line: brainstorm for volume, outline for bones, draft with your chosen division, finalize with your own voice — step four is not outsourceable, and bylines stay honest.
2. Pictures take four elements: subject, style, details, mood. The description is the steering wheel; follow-up craft transfers whole; precision-heavy images stumble — use it for sketches and sparks.
3. Copyright is still settling: private use freely, commercial use after reading the terms; homage yes, impersonating living creators no.

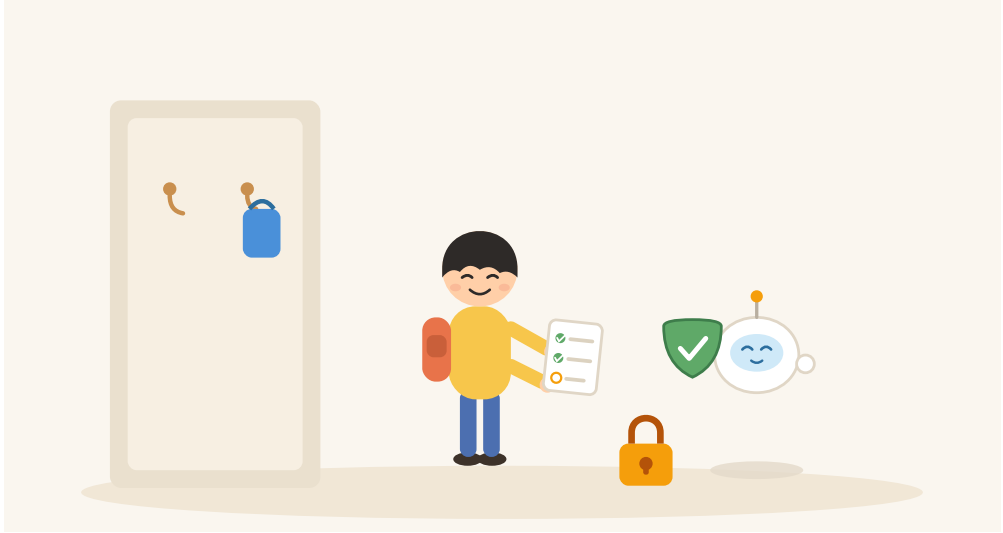
Try It Yourself: Make a Card

Someone near you has a birthday coming (or has earned a thank-you). Make them a card: polish a fifty-word message through the four writing steps, then paint a matching picture with the four elements.

Then — actually send it. The other chapters' lessons stick once practiced. This chapter's work warms up once given away.

(End of Chapter 7. Next: Chapter 8, "The Safety Manual" — the more useful the tool, the safer the habits.)

Chapter 8 • The Safety Manual



To Be Clear: This Isn't to Scare You — It's to Equip You

The last required course before the finale. Eight chapters in, your hands are getting quick — and the quicker the hands, the more they should know where the edges are.

Reassurance first: nine-tenths of AI-related safety problems are prevented by a few simple disciplines. This chapter spreads no anxiety. It hands out equipment — four pieces.

Equipment One: the Do-Not-Feed List — Three Things Stay Off the Table

Chatting with AI feels natural — natural enough to forget the other side isn't your confidant. Three kinds of information stay unsent, however smoothly the conversation flows:

One: identity and wallet. ID numbers, card numbers, passwords, and one-time verification codes. Codes get their own underline: no scenario exists in which they should be told to any "person" — AI included.

Two: company property. Internal data, client records, unannounced plans. Chapter 5's discipline now goes on the record: when unsure, anonymize first — real names and figures become "a client," "\$X" — or better, don't send at all.

Three: other people's privacy. A friend's illness, a colleague's dispute, a family member's secret. Your information is yours to share. Theirs is not yours to give.

One universal self-test before hitting send: **would you pin this sentence on the community notice board?** Yes — send freely. Hesitating — don't.

Why the caution? Not because AI "turns evil," but because of a plain fact: **once information leaves you, it leaves your control** — how it's stored, for how long, whether it ever leaks, none of that is yours to decide anymore. The only reliable control is control at the source.

Equipment Two: Tiered Verification — Bigger Stakes, Deeper Checks

Book One gave you three self-defense moves; Chapter 5 drilled source-checking. Here they merge into one tiered system:

Small things — just use it (green). Recipes, ideas, rewrites: mistakes don't hurt, checking would waste the gift.

Medium things — cross-check once (yellow). Knowledge you'll repeat to others, numbers going into documents: check one other source — a quick search, the original text, or the same question to a second AI to compare.

Big things — use the front door (red). Health, law, money. Treat its words as pre-reading; final answers come from official channels and licensed professionals. **Bringing its analysis to your doctor or lawyer is smart use. Bringing it instead of your doctor or lawyer is dangerous use.**

Equipment Three: Know the New Scams — Voices and Faces Can Be Forged

Book One, Chapter 5 left a sentence behind: "seeing is no longer believing." Now it lands on the scenario that matters most: **AI can clone voices and faces.** A few seconds of audio can forge a convincing voice; the face on a video call can be synthetic.

Hence the new scam: your "son" calls — the voice is uncanny — something's happened, money is needed now. Your "boss" sends a voice memo ordering an urgent transfer. The voice is genuinely similar. The story is fake.

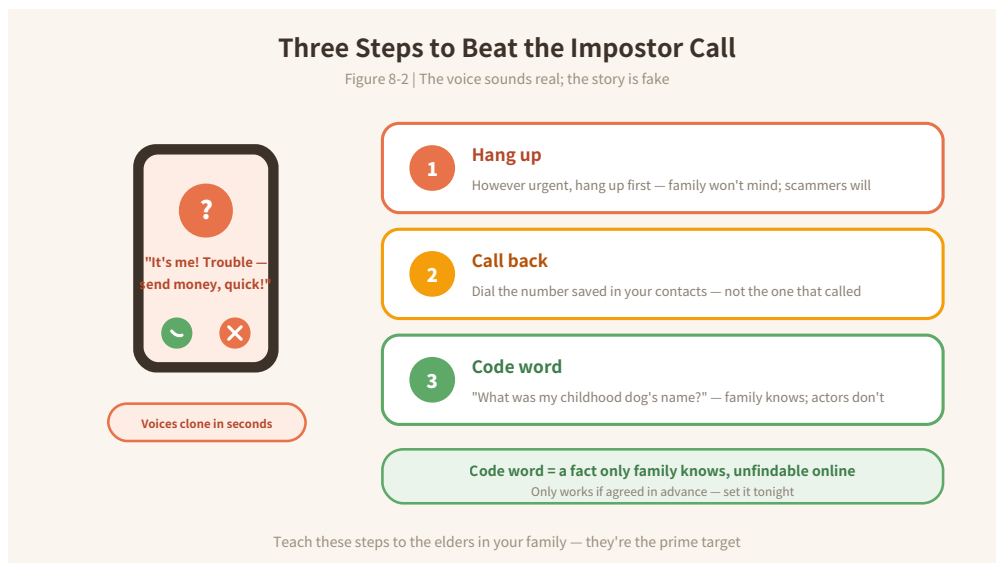
Three steps defeat it. Memorize them:

One: hang up. However urgent, hang up first. Real family won't come to harm because you hung up; only scammers fear the click.

Two: call back. Dial **the number saved in your contacts** — never the number that called you.

Three: use the code word. Once connected, ask about **a small fact only your family knows and the internet cannot find**: "What was the name of the dog I had in primary school?" "Who got carsick on our last family trip?" Family answers; actors can't.

A code word only works if agreed in advance. So if this chapter leaves you with a single action item, it's this: **set the family code word tonight**. And walk the three steps through with the elders in your family, hands-on — they are this scam's heaviest casualty zone.



Equipment Four: Tame the Recommendation Algorithm

Finally, a promise from Book One comes due.

The bottomless short videos, the news that makes you angrier the longer you scroll, the identical opinions — behind them is the old acquaintance from Book One's very first chapter: the recommendation algorithm. It learns patterns from your every pause; whatever you watch, it feeds you harder. Give it long enough and your world narrows to what it serves.

Tame it back, three moves:

Search on purpose. Want something? Search for it directly — active choices correct its portrait of you. Don't live on the feed alone.

Use "not interested." That button is the rein in your hand. Pull it without apology.

Schedule jailbreaks. Deliberately read outside your circle — the other side's coverage, an unfamiliar field's explainer. Add roughage to your information diet.

It's learning your patterns. You've read Book One — you know exactly how it learns. **This time, you be the teacher.**

Chapter Takeaways

1. The do-not-feed list, three kinds: identity and wallet, company property, other people's privacy — one test: would you pin it on the notice board?

2. Tiered verification: small things just use, medium things cross-check once, big things go through official channels and professionals — AI is pre-reading, not a verdict.
3. Voices and faces can be forged: family asks for money → hang up, call back, code word — set the code word tonight. And the algorithm can be tamed: search on purpose, press "not interested," schedule jailbreaks.

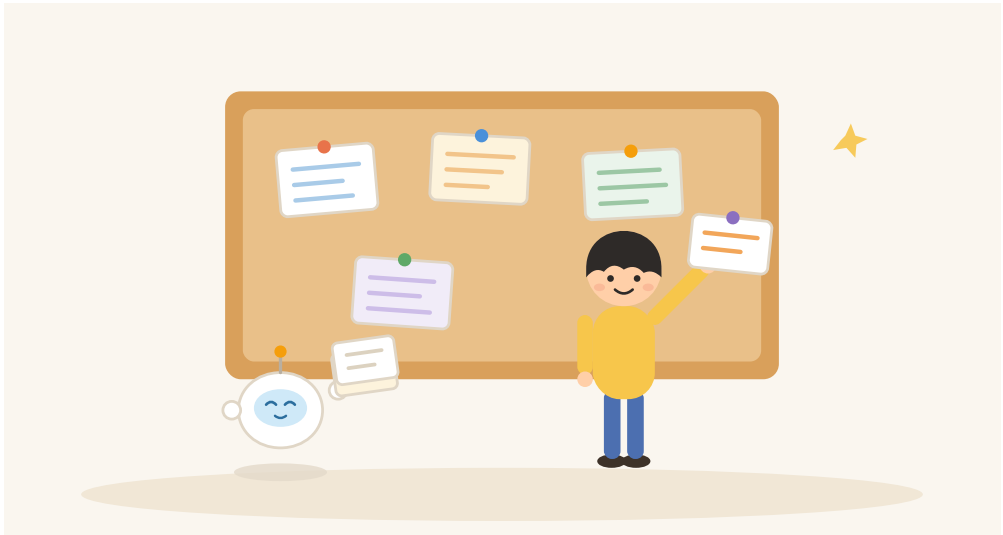
Try It Yourself: Two Tasks, Twenty Minutes

Task one: agree on the family code word, and teach the three steps — hang up, call back, code word — to the elders in your family. Possibly the best-value twenty minutes in this entire book.

Task two: scroll back through your AI chats and check whether anything from the do-not-feed list ever went out. If so, no panic: delete the conversation and mind it from now on. The armor protects from the day you put it on.

(End of Chapter 8. Next: Chapter 9, "Your Personal AI Workflow" — the finale.)

Chapter 9 • Your Personal AI Workflow



The Final Chapter: Assembling the Machine

Eight chapters have filled your hands with good parts: four building blocks, five follow-up lines, four template cards, a three-step reading loop, three magic lines, a do-not-feed list...

The final chapter does one thing: **assemble the parts into a machine of your own** — so that using AI shifts from "when I remember to" to "as a matter of course." Three assembly steps.

Step One: Build a Scenario Card Box

The method is embarrassingly low-tech and extremely effective: **create a note on your phone titled "AI Card Box."**

Each time AI helps you finish something well, save a "card." Three lines per card is plenty:

Scenario — one line: "birthday wishes for an elder." **Opening ask** — paste the exact prompt that worked. **Watch-outs** — one line: "verify prices myself," "double-check names."

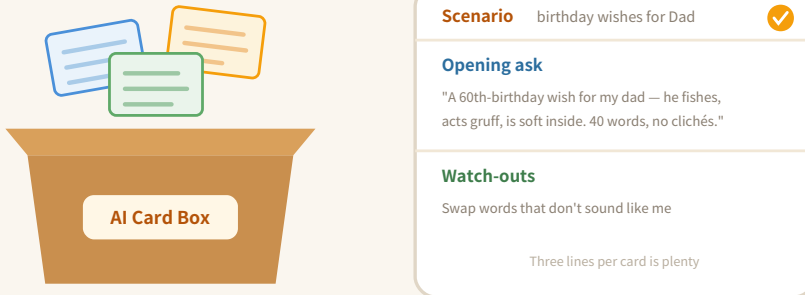
Next time the same kind of job appears, open the box, change a few words, go — you never start from zero again.

This book has already drafted your starter deck: the three starter questions, the four template cards, the reading loop, the three magic lines... Move in whichever ones you've actually used and liked.

The card box's quiet magic: **it grows your feel for the craft, not the book's.** A prompt you've polished through three rounds fits you better than any printed template ever will. Six months from now, that box is your own — the only copy in existence — AI user manual.

Your Scenario Card Box

Figure 9-1 | Get something done, save a card



Starter deck included: starter questions • template cards • the reading loop • three magic lines

It grows your feel, not the book's — in six months it's your own AI manual

Step Two: One New Scenario per Week

Habits aren't built on enthusiasm; they're built on rhythm. Here's a rhythm that fits: **open exactly one new scenario each week.**

This week, try delegated reading. Used it well? Save the card. Next week, mock interviews. One at a time. No binging.

It outlasts the "use everything at once" burst of week one — a tool enters a life not through excitement but through the accumulation of small victories: that actually helped. Nine scenarios, nine weeks. Look back after a season and you'll startle yourself.

Step Three: Teach One Family Member

Of everything in this book, this is the request that matters most.

Think of who needs it: the father who wants to write something for his grandson? The partner drowning in work group-chats? The child with ten thousand questions about the world?

Pick the chapter that fits them best, sit down beside them, and watch them send their first message. Don't do it for them — let their own finger press send. The threshold you crossed in Chapter 1, walk them across it too.

Somewhere in the teaching you'll notice something wonderful: explaining it to them made it clearer to you. Chapter 6's Feynman method, reporting for one last shift.

While you're at it, set the family code word from Chapter 8 together. Safety only counts when the whole family carries it.

The Road to Book Three

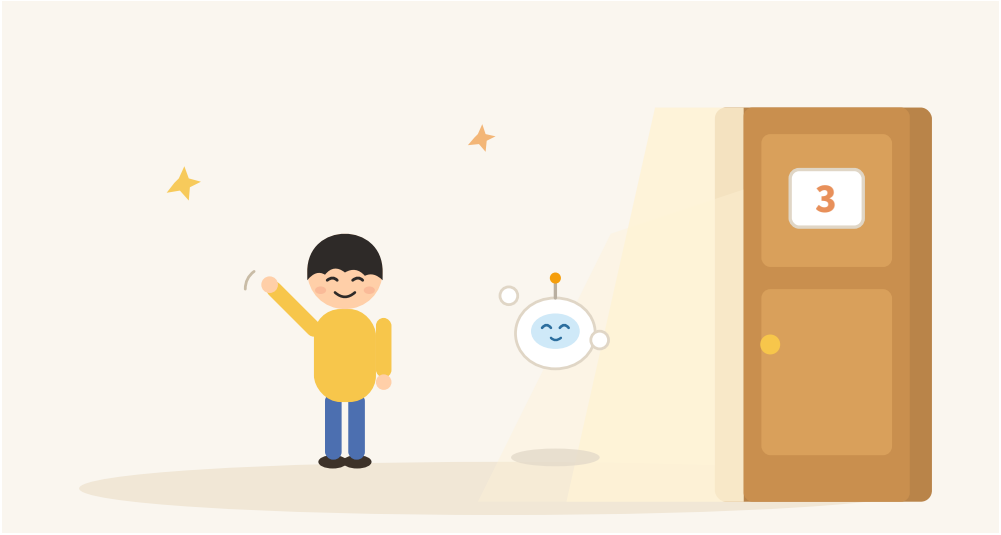
Here, Book Two's mission is complete: AI has gone from "I hear it's amazing" to a tool that sits comfortably in your hand.

But once a tool grows familiar, new questions surface on their own —

Will it reshape my job? Should the kids still write their own homework? Will my parents get fooled by it? Of everything on my screen, how much is still real? And that endless argument about AI rules in the news — what is it actually about?

These questions share one trait: they're no longer about "how do **I** use it," but "how do **we** live with it." That is Book Three, *Living with AI*.

The door plate with the "3" is already hung.



The Whole Book in Three Sentences

Book One left three sentences; Book Two leaves three as well:

1. **A good answer = context + follow-ups.** Four blocks set the start; five lines polish the finish — it never tires, so keep polishing.
2. **The traffic light runs the division of labor.** Green: hand it over. Yellow: spot-check. Red: your call. Keep the do-not-feed list in mind, and set the family code word tonight.
3. **Sparring, never substituting — and keep the card box growing.** Let it do the work, never the thinking. How you use it decides whether it is your amplifier or your stand-in.

Try It Yourself: A Fresh List

Pull out the three-thing list from the Preface. By this page, everything on it should be done — and if something isn't, flip back to its chapter and finish it today.

Then take a fresh sheet and write three new things: one for work, one for life, one you've always wanted to learn.

This list doesn't go between the pages. Go do it. You don't need a tutorial anymore.

(End of Chapter 9 — and of Book Two, Putting AI to Work. Book Three, Living with AI: don't be a stranger.)